

D333

Ethics in Technology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A city transit board is deciding whether to install cameras on buses. Analysts project fewer assaults and injuries for about 200,000 daily riders and modest privacy costs. The system would come from a vendor based in Ohio and be installed over the winter. One board member argues for approval because it produces the greatest overall benefit for the most people. Which framework is she using?

- A. Virtue ethics.
- B. Ethical relativism, since the vendor is from another state.
- C. Deontology.
- D. Utilitarianism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Option A helps 1,000 people by 3 units each but harms 200 people by 10 units each. Option B helps 400 people by 5 units each and harms no one. Which option does a utilitarian choose?

- A. Option A, with a net of 1,000 versus 400 for B.
- B. Option B, with a net gain of 2,000 units versus 1,000 for A.
- C. Neither, because any harm at all is forbidden.
- D. Option A, because it helps more people.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A social media company's data team wants to secretly change what users see in their feeds to study effects on mood. The study would run for one week across 700,000 accounts, and the team has a strong publication record. An ethicist objects that users would be treated merely as means to the company's goals without their consent. Which framework is the ethicist applying?

- A. Social contract theory, because 700,000 users form a community.
- B. Utilitarianism.
- C. Deontology (Kantian ethics).
- D. Virtue ethics.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A policy would benefit 9,000 people but relies on using 1,000 people's personal data without their consent. Which argument would a deontologist make?

- A.** The policy is fine if the benefits are twice as large as the harms.
- B.** Using people's data without consent is wrong in itself, however many others benefit.
- C.** The policy is right if the people carrying it out have good character.
- D.** The policy is right because 9,000 beneficiaries outnumber 1,000 affected people.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A junior engineer at a drone startup must decide whether to report a safety shortcut her team took. She asks herself what an honest and courageous engineer would do in her place. The startup recently raised \$8 million and moved into a new office. Which framework is she using?

- A.** Ethical egoism, since the startup just raised money.
- B.** Deontology.
- C.** Virtue ethics.
- D.** Utilitarianism.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A data broker legally buys location data from app makers and sells profiles showing which users visit health clinics. Its practices comply with every law in its state, and it has 150 employees. Which statement is most accurate?

- A.** The practice may still be unethical, because legality does not settle the privacy harm or lack of real consent.
- B.** The practice is ethical because it is legal.
- C.** The practice is ethical because a firm of 150 people has limited reach.
- D.** The practice is illegal everywhere, because health data is always protected.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

An employer's wellness program collected step counts from fitness trackers to award prizes. Leaders now want to use the same data to help choose employees for layoffs. The trackers were bought in bulk at a 20 percent discount. What is the core ethical problem?

- A. Discounted trackers produce inaccurate data.
- B. Collecting any employee data is always unethical.
- C. There is no problem, since the company owns the devices.
- D. Using the data for a purpose employees never consented to.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A lender trains a credit model on ten years of past approvals from a period when it rarely lent in certain zip codes. The model does not use race as an input. It runs on a new cloud platform and scores applications in under a second. Why might it still discriminate?

- A. Past lending patterns and proxies like zip code can carry old bias into the model.
- B. It cannot discriminate, because race is not an input.
- C. All algorithms are biased and cannot be improved.
- D. Fast models are less accurate and therefore unfair.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An audit shows a hiring model rejects qualified women at twice the rate of qualified men. Which step most directly addresses the cause?

- A. Stop auditing, since audits create legal exposure.
- B. Hire more engineers for the team.
- C. Remove only the gender field from the model.
- D. Review and rebalance the training data, test for proxy features, and re-audit outcomes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A student downloads a copyrighted textbook PDF from a file-sharing site. The bookstore price is \$180, and she already owns an older edition. Which description is most accurate?

- A. Plagiarism.
- B. Legal, because she already owns an older edition.
- C. Piracy: copyright infringement, regardless of price or older copies.
- D. Fair use, since it is for education.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A blogger copies paragraphs from an 1850s novel that is in the public domain into her post without saying where they came from. What is the issue?

- A. Plagiarism, but not copyright infringement.
- B. Both plagiarism and piracy.
- C. Copyright infringement.
- D. No issue, because public-domain text can never raise ethical concerns.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A school district gives every student a laptop. Six months later, students in rural areas still fall behind on online homework. The laptops came with a three-year warranty and a district logo. What best explains the gap?

- A. Rural students will always lag, whatever support they receive.
- B. Devices alone do not close the divide; home broadband and support also matter.
- C. The divide should be closed now that every student has a device.
- D. The warranty is too short.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A city transit board is deciding whether to install cameras on buses. Analysts project fewer assaults and injuries for about 200,000 daily riders and modest privacy costs. ~~The system would come from a vendor based in Ohio and be installed over the winter.~~ One board member argues for approval because it produces the greatest overall benefit for the most people. Which framework is she using?

Target word: name the framework **Decides:** Weighing total benefits against costs.

A	Adjacent category	Virtue ethics asks about character, not outcomes.
B	Camouflage	Vendor location does not decide her reasoning.
C	Confusion set	Deontology judges duties and rights, not totals.
D	Correct	She judges the choice by its total consequences.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Option A helps 1,000 people by 3 units each but harms 200 people by 10 units each. Option B helps 400 people by 5 units each and harms no one. Which option does a utilitarian choose?

Target word: compute net utility **Decides:** A nets $3,000 - 2,000 = 1,000$; B nets 2,000.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses B's head count instead of its total benefit.
B	Correct	$400 \times 5 = 2,000$ beats $1,000 \times 3 - 200 \times 10 = 1,000$.
C	Absolute language	That is a duty-based rule; utilitarians weigh harms rather than banning them.
D	Dropped element	Ignores the harms to the 200 people.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A social media company's data team wants to secretly change what users see in their feeds to study effects on mood. ~~The study would run for one week across 700,000 accounts, and the team has a strong publication record.~~ An ethicist objects that users would be treated merely as means to the company's goals without their consent. Which framework is the ethicist applying?

Target word: name the framework **Decides:** "Merely as means" and consent = duty-based ethics.

A	Camouflage	Sample size does not decide the framework.
B	Confusion set	A utilitarian would weigh total results, not the use of people as means.
C	Correct	The objection rests on duties to respect people and get consent.
D	Adjacent category	The objection is about duty and consent, not the researchers' character.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A policy would benefit 9,000 people but relies on using 1,000 people's personal data without their consent. Which argument would a deontologist make?

Target word: produce the deontological argument — reverse of naming the framework **Decides:** Consent and treating people as ends outweigh totals.

A	Dropped element	Drops the consent requirement and weighs outcomes instead.
B	Correct	Duty-based ethics rejects using people merely as means, regardless of outcome.
C	Adjacent category	That is virtue reasoning, not duty.
D	Inverted operation	That is the utilitarian argument.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A junior engineer at a drone startup must decide whether to report a safety shortcut her team took. She asks herself what an honest and courageous engineer would do in her place. ~~The startup recently raised \$8 million and moved into a new office.~~ Which framework is she using?

Target word: name the framework **Decides:** Reasoning from character traits.

A	Camouflage	Funding news does not decide her reasoning.
B	Adjacent category	Deontology asks which rule or duty applies, not what a good person would do.
C	Correct	She reasons from the traits of a good person.
D	Confusion set	She is not adding up outcomes.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A data broker legally buys location data from app makers and sells profiles showing which users visit health clinics. Its practices comply with every law in its state, ~~and it has 150 employees.~~ Which statement is most accurate?

Target word: legal vs. ethical judgment **Decides:** Legal compliance does not settle ethics.

A	Correct	Law is a floor, not the full ethical test.
B	Adjacent category	Treats legal compliance as the same as ethics.
C	Camouflage	Company size does not decide the ethics.
D	Absolute language	Health privacy laws cover specific entities; the stem says it is legal here.

7. Answer D Concept 5

An employer's wellness program collected step counts from fitness trackers to award prizes. Leaders now want to use the same data to help choose employees for layoffs. ~~The trackers were bought in bulk at a 20 percent discount.~~ What is the core ethical problem?

Target word: core ethical problem **Decides:** New use beyond what employees agreed to.

A	Camouflage	Price does not decide the ethical issue.
B	Absolute language	Collection with consent for a stated purpose can be fine.
C	Dropped element	Owning hardware does not remove the consent issue.
D	Correct	Reuse beyond the original purpose breaks informed consent.

8. Answer A Concept 6

A lender trains a credit model on ten years of past approvals from a period when it rarely lent in certain zip codes. The model does not use race as an input. ~~It runs on a new cloud platform and scores applications in under a second.~~ Why might it still discriminate?

Target word: source of bias **Decides:** Biased history plus zip code as a proxy.

A	Correct	Proxies correlated with race reproduce discrimination.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out proxy variables.
C	Absolute language	Bias can be measured and reduced.
D	Camouflage	Speed does not decide bias.

9. Answer D Concept 6 · transfer

An audit shows a hiring model rejects qualified women at twice the rate of qualified men. Which step most directly addresses the cause?

Target word: remedy from the outcome — reverse **Decides:** The cause lies in training data and proxies.

A	Inverted operation	Hides the problem instead of fixing it.
B	Adjacent category	Staffing does not address the data cause.
C	Dropped element	Proxies for gender remain.
D	Correct	Targets where the bias comes from and checks the result.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A student downloads a copyrighted textbook PDF from a file-sharing site. ~~The bookstore price is \$180, and she already owns an older edition.~~ Which description is most accurate?

Target word: classify the act **Decides:** Copying protected work without permission.

A	Adjacent category	Plagiarism is failing to credit, not copying without permission.
B	Camouflage	Owning an older edition gives no rights to the new one.
C	Correct	Unauthorized copying of protected work is piracy.
D	Confusion set	Copying an entire textbook is not fair use.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

A blogger copies paragraphs from an 1850s novel that is in the public domain into her post without saying where they came from. What is the issue?

Target word: classify — reverse case with no copyright **Decides:** No copyright, but no credit.

A	Correct	Public-domain text is free to copy but still needs credit.
B	Adjacent category	Piracy requires protected work.
C	Inverted operation	Public-domain works have no copyright.
D	Absolute language	Passing off others' words is still plagiarism.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A school district gives every student a laptop. Six months later, students in rural areas still fall behind on online homework. ~~The laptops came with a three-year warranty and a district logo.~~ What best explains the gap?

Target word: cause of the remaining gap **Decides:** Devices alone do not provide home internet or support.

A	Absolute language	Gaps respond to targeted support.
B	Correct	The divide includes connectivity and skills, not just hardware.
C	Dropped element	Drops connectivity and skills.
D	Camouflage	The warranty does not decide homework completion.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	3	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Utilitarianism	The right choice produces the greatest total good minus harm for everyone affected.	Counting only how many people benefit and ignoring the size of harms.	"Greatest good," totals of benefits and harms.
2	Deontology	Some actions are right or wrong in themselves; people must be treated as ends, never merely as means, whatever the outcome.	Assuming good results can justify deceiving or using people.	Duty, rights, consent, or "used as a means."
3	Virtue ethics	Ask what a person of good character (honest, courageous, fair) would do.	Confusing character-based reasoning with rule-following.	"What would a good or honest person do?"
4	Legal is not the same as ethical	Compliance with law is a floor; an action can be legal and still unethical.	Ending the analysis once something is legal.	"Complies with every law" in a harmful scenario.
5	Consent and purpose limits	Data collected for one purpose should not be reused for a different purpose without informed consent.	Thinking ownership of the device or database settles the question.	Data gathered for X now wanted for Y.
6	Algorithmic bias	Models trained on biased history can discriminate through proxy variables even when protected traits are left out.	Believing removing the race or gender field removes bias.	Historical training data plus a proxy like zip code.
7	Plagiarism vs. piracy	Plagiarism is failing to credit someone's work; piracy is copying protected work without permission. One can occur without the other.	Treating them as the same wrong, or thinking education makes copying fair use.	Public-domain text (no copyright) or credited-but-unlicensed copies.
8	The digital divide	The divide includes access to devices and broadband, digital skills, and support; handing out devices alone does not close it.	Declaring the gap closed once everyone has a device.	Devices distributed but outcomes still lag.

Course scope (public description): Ethics in Technology examines the ethical considerations of technology use in the 21st century and introduces students to a decision-making process informed by ethical frameworks. Students will study specific cases related to important topics such as surveillance, social media, hacking, data manipulation, plagiarism and piracy, artificial intelligence, responsible innovation, and the digital divide. This course has no prerequisites.